T/TH 11-12:15PM I Car Barn 201

ENGL4091 Sec.01

Topics in 19c British Literature: Situationships

CLASS DESCRIPTION

A "situationship" is a relationship that breaks norms of monogamy, intimacy, or commitment. More accurately, it is a romantic entanglement defined by its being UNdefined. This class will take a look at the power dynamics of personal, social, and global "situationships" of 19th century British literature. Each text will engage with this subject in one or more of the following frameworks:

1. The text has a classic romantic and/or sexual "situationship" between two(ish) people.
2. The text overtly engages with questions about the British empire/power relations between metropole/colonies and/or globalization.
3. The text uses a romantic situationship as a screen to covertly engage with a political situationship.

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

LINDSEY E. R. O'NEIL, PHD

Office Hours by appointment (In person or Zoom)

Think of my office hours as an extension of the classroom. I am happy to discuss any aspect of your writing or reading, as well as any questions you may have about class procedures or requirements. You may "stop in" my [Zoom] office whenever you like. I ask that you give me at least 15 min to figure out where my laptop and Zoom login is when scheduling.

CLASS POLICIES

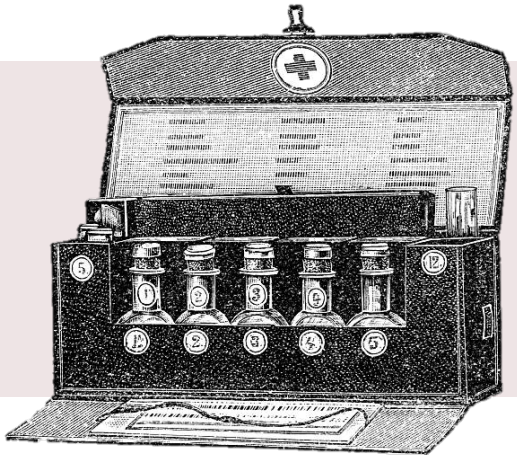
ATTENDANCE & PARTICIPATION: This class is *primarily discussion based*. You will be expected to come prepared to discuss the day's assigned text. This means you should be contributing *substantially* to discussion in each class period. You are also required to bring the assigned text to class on the day it is to be discussed. If you miss class for any reason, it will be your responsibility to find out what you missed and how you can make up the work from another student.

The class' participation rubric can be found on Canvas; more information on Georgetown's Attendance/Absence Policy can be found online.

LATE WORK: Assignments are due on the date and time designated on the course syllabus. Late papers will be marked down one-half letter grade per day late, including weekends. If you must submit a late paper, you should contact me the day the paper is due.

TECHNOLOGY: You may use a laptop or tablet for PDFs posted on Canvas. If these technologies become a distraction, I reserve the right to revoke this privilege. The first disruption will result in a warning; The second time your phone disrupts class, you will bring cookies in for the entire class the next class meeting. *Lack of attention due to technology will also be factored into your participation grade.*

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY: Plagiarism, whether it is submitting someone else's work as your own, submitting your own work completed for another class, using AI without pre-approval, or otherwise violating the University's code of Academic Integrity, will not be tolerated. Please contact me before submitting work if you are uncertain of the definition of these academic violations and their potential consequences.



ASSIGNMENTS

PARTICIPATION:
30% of Final Grade.
Active and repeated participation in class and group work. This includes bringing in questions, observations, passages that confused you, and so on. Texts and drafts should be brought on the days they are assigned.

CO-LEADING DISCUSSION (3):
Completion grades/25% total
At the beginning of the semester, you will sign up in groups of 3-4 for 3 dates to lead discussion. By 12am on your discussion date, you will post on our class GoogleDoc 1) a one-paragraph summary of the reading or an annotated section of the reading <u>and</u> 2) at least 3 questions for class debate and discussion.

REFLECTIVE PROJECT (3):
15% each/45% of Final Grade.
These projects can take the form of a literary close reading, a response essay to a provided question, or an unessay project. In-depth explanations of the types of projects can be found on Canvas. I am also open to discussing other options; bring all ideas to me!

PAPER FORMAT:
Unless otherwise indicated, the standard format is:

- double-spaced throughout (with no extra spaces between paragraphs)
- Arial/Times New Roman/Calibri (12 point, no italics except for titles or emphasis)
- one-inch margins on all sides, left justified
- your name, my name, the section number for the course
- title of the paper center justified
- numbered pages

When you cite information, you should follow MLA style guidelines.

COURSE SCHEDULE

Week 1 Introductions & Foundations
TH Aug 28 Syllabus Day (feat. painful ice breakers).

Week 2 Persuasion
T Sept 2 No class (Monday schedule).
TH Sept 4 Austen, *Persuasion* Ch 1-6 (1817); Psomiades, "Reading Marriage in Victorian Novels" & "Marriage and Social Theory" (2023); Schor, "Love" (2018).

Week 3 Persuasion
T Sept 9 Austen Ch 7-10; Frey, "A Nation without Nationalism: The Reorganization of Feeling in Austen's *Persuasion*" (2005).
TH Sept 11 Austen Ch 11-14.

Week 4 Persuasion
T Sept 16 Austen Ch 15-21; Harris, "Domestic Virtues and National Importance" (2007).
TH Sept 18 Austen Ch 22-25.

Week 5 Friendzoned
T Sept 23 Tennyson, "Locksley Hall" (1835/42); Ebbatson, "Tennyson's 'Locksley Hall': Progress and Destitution" (2013)
TH Sep 25 Tennyson, "Locksley Hall" (1835/42); McClintock, "The Lay of the Land: Genealogies of Imperialism" (1995).

Reflective Project 1 due Sunday, Sept. 28th, at 11:59PM.

Week 6 North & South I
T Sept 29 Gaskell, *North and South* Ch 1-6 (1854-55)
TH Oct 2 Gaskell, Ch 7-12; Puri, "Indian Objects, English Body" (2017).

Week 7 North & South II
T Oct 7 Gaskell, Ch 13-18.
TH Oct 9 Gaskell, Ch 19-22; Harman, "In Promiscuous Company" (1988).

Week 8 North & South III
T Oct 14 Gaskell, Ch 23-28.
TH Oc 16 Gaskell, Ch 29-33; Reeder, "Broken Bodies, Permeable Subjects" (2013).

ACCESSIBILITY

Your success in the class is important to me. If there are circumstances that may affect your performance in this class, please let me know as soon as possible so that we can work together to develop strategies for adapting assignments to meet both your needs and the requirements of the course. If your name or pronouns need to be corrected, please let me know. If you have questions or concerns regarding physical, digital, or course accessibility, you may also contact arc@georgetown.edu or visit https://academicsupport.georgetown.edu/disability/.

COURSE CONTENT NOTE: Due to the nature of this course, we will be discussing historical events and texts that may be disturbing, even traumatizing, to some students. If you ever feel the need to step outside during one of these discussions, either for a short time or for the rest of the class session, you may always do so without academic penalty (You will, however, be responsible for any material you miss. If you do leave the room for a significant time, please make arrangements to get notes from another student or see me individually.)

COURSE SCHEDULE

Week 9 North & South IV
T Oct 21 Gaskell, Ch 34-39.
TH Oc 23 Gaskell, Ch 40-42; Lee, "The Return of the 'Unnative'" (2007).

Week 10 North & South V
T Oct 28 Gaskell, Ch 43-48.
TH Oct 30 Gaskell, Ch 49-End; Clausson, "Romancing Manchester" (2007).

Reflective Project 2 due Sunday, Nov 2nd, at 11:59PM.

Week 11 White Women Tears
T Nov 4 Craik, *The Half-Caste* (1851/97); Marcus, Selection from *Between Women* (2007).
TH Nov 6 Craik, *The Half-Caste* (1851/97).

Week 12 White Women Tears
T Nov 11 Selections from Carpenter, *Six Months in India* (1868); Burton, "Fearful Bodies into Disciplined Subjects" (1995).
TH Nov 13 Selections from 19th C New Woman periodicals; Minocha, "Queen Victoria through Punjabi Eyes: The Travel Writings of Hardevi" (2024).

Week 13 Spring Fling (jk it's imperialism)
T Nov 18 Marsh, *The Beetle* (1897) Ch 1-16.
TH Nov 20 Marsh, Ch 17-22.

Week 14 Thanksgiving Asynchronous Project
T Nov 25 Marsh, Ch. 23- 31; Asynchronous Project (No class).
TH Nov 27 Thanksgiving!

Week 15 Spring Fling (jk it's imperialism)
T Dec 2 Marsh, Ch 32-45.
TH Dec 4 Marsh, Ch 46-End.

Week 16 Workshop
T Dec 9 Workshop for Reflective Project 3/Final Project.

Reflective Project 3 due Sunday, Dec 14th, at 11:59PM.